

BISHOP MICHAEL ROUTER will be installed as the new Bishop of Derry next Sunday, 20 September, in St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry, at 3.00pm. As the diocese and parishes prepare to celebrate this joyous occasion, Bishop McKeown has invited the priests of the diocese to hold special times of prayer in our parishes this week, to pray for Bishop Router as he takes up the responsibility of leading and serving the people of the diocese as Bishop. In our Pastoral Area we will have special prayers for Bishop Router at our 10.00am weekday Masses this week - on **Wednesday (Drumquin), Thursday (Aghyaran) and Friday (Castlederg)**. Children from our primary schools will attend these Masses. You are invited to come along, if you can, to join in prayer for Bishop Router at this significant time for him and for our diocese. We will also have special prayers at our Masses next weekend.

This is also a significant week for Bishop McKeown, who will retire as of next Sunday. At this time of transition for him, you are asked to keep Bishop McKeown in your prayers too.

PASTORAL VISITATION OF THE HOUSEBOUND will take place this week as follows:

Monday 14 September: Drumquin Town Area - Segully Road, McCreagh Park, Castlederg Road, Main Street, Creaghmore Road, Fairgreen Gardens and Loughrey Terrace, commencing at 11.00am - Fr Thomas.

ST VINCENT DE PAUL members will meet in the Parochial House, Drumquin this Wednesday, 16 September, at 7.30pm. If you would like to become involved in SVP, you are very welcome to come along to this meeting.

PIONEER MEETING will take place in the Parochial House, Drumquin, this Thursday, 17 September, at 7.30pm.

QUEEN'S UNIVERSITY CATHOLIC CHAPLAINCY reopens for the new academic year on Monday 14 September, with weekday Masses and our semester programme resuming. The first Sunday Mass will be celebrated on 20 September at the new, earlier time of 7.00pm. Find out about what's on, ways to connect and get involved, and student accommodation at Ryan Hall at qubcatholic.org and on our socials. Visit our newly renewed Chaplaincy at 28 Elmwood Avenue for Mass, Confessions or candle-lighting — and call into Mosaic for coffee, hot lunches and home-baked treats.

YOGA CLASS: Aghyaran Development Association in conjunction with HARC is commencing a 6-week Yogo class for over 50's in Aghyaran Centre, commencing Tues 15 September, 11.30am - 12.30pm. Contact Jerry on 078 6492 9344.

LINE DANCING in Garvagh Hall commences on Monday 21 September: Absolute Beginners – 6.00pm - 7.30pm; High Beginners/Improvers - 7.45pm - 9.30pm. Doors open 5.45pm. Adults £7, Children under 10 £5 (must be accompanied by an adult). Wear comfortable footwear and bring a bottle of water.

HOST FOR HOSPICE: October is officially Foyle Hospice Coffee Morning Month. We are calling on supporters to help us raise vital funds by hosting a Coffee Morning. Whether it's at home, work or in your local community, you can support your local hospice by bringing your friends together and putting the kettle on - it's a piece of cake! To request your FREE host pack or for more info, please call Ailbhe McDaid on 028 7135 9888 or email: ailbhe@foylehospice.com

EARLY TO TALK ABOUT CHRISTMAS, BUT TROCAIRE WANT TO KNOW - Could You Help Share the True Spirit of Christmas? Each year, volunteers in parishes across the north of Ireland set up a small stall after Masses to sell **Trócaire's Gifts of Change** — meaningful gifts that make a real difference to families living in poverty around the world. We provide everything you need, including training and support. If you would like to find out more about how you can help, please email Mark at mark.mcmahon@trocaire.org or call **028 9080 8030**.

Season of Creation 2026: 1 September to 4 October

With the theme of 'Living Water' for this year's Season of Creation, we pray:

Holy God, whose Spirit hovered over the waters at the beginning,
we gather as part of your community of all creation, thirsty for your grace.
We give thanks for the gift of water, the veins of our common home,
that sustains the cedar and the whale, the pasture and the city.
We are grateful for the local waters that nourish our homelands and our fellow creatures.
We give thanks that in your well-watered garden, every drop is a sacred testament to your love.
Yet, we confess that we have treated this gift as a mere commodity.
We have choked the seas with our waste and watched the warming tides rise in judgment.
Melt our frozen hearts, O God, and let the waters of repentance flow.
Lord of all Life, you promised that wherever the river flows, everything shall live.
Stir in us a calling to care for the waters and to honour the dignity of the thirsty.
May your Word be a spring within us, gushing forth for the healing of the nations.
May Christ our Lord who is Living Water refresh us for the work of restoration.
And may the Holy Spirit carry us on currents of grace until justice rolls down like waters
and righteousness like an ever-flowing stream. Amen.

Parishes of Camus, Clonleigh and Leckpatrick

Twenty-Third Sunday in Ordinary Time – Year A – 13th September 2026

Parish Clergy

Fr Michael McCaughey, PP: (028) 71882274 / (028) 71882215

Fr Declan Boland (priest in residence)

Email: leckpatrickparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.leckpatrickparish.com

Email: strabaneparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.camusparish.com

Email: clonleighparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.clonleighparish.com

Thoughts on the Gospel (*Matthew 18:21-35*)

The gospel today tells of Peter asking Jesus how many times he should forgive someone who wrongs him. Jesus responds with a parable: a servant forgiven of an immense debt refuses to forgive a fellow servant of a small debt. The lesson is clear: those who receive mercy must extend mercy.

Forgiveness begins with humility, recognising our own frailty and the mercy we have received. It is not weakness, but strength rooted in grace. Humility opens our hearts to God's mercy and enables us to extend that same mercy to others.

Forgiveness also requires empathy. By seeing the humanity of those who hurt us, we can respond with compassion without excusing wrongdoing. In forgiving, we honour the forgiveness we ourselves have received and become stewards of grace. Ultimately, forgiveness reshapes our hearts, relationships, and communities, making us more like the One who forgives endlessly.

The parable of the unforgiving servant is not just a warning; it is an invitation. It calls us to live with a HEART shaped by humility, empathy, accountability, release, and transformation. Forgiveness is not easy, but it is essential. When we forgive, we reflect the very heart of God. And in doing so, we discover freedom, peace, and the joy of a life lived in mercy.

Lord, help us forgive with humble hearts and share your mercy with others. Amen.

A Time of Prayer in Honour of St Pio As we prepare to celebrate the feast day of St Pio on Wednesday 23rd September, we invite all to take part in a Novena of Prayer beginning on **Monday 14th September**. Prayer cards will be available in the coming days for people to offer prayers to St Pio. Prayer and reflection on the life of St Pio will be included in weekend Masses on 19th and 20th September. Please note that Mass will be celebrated in Sacred Heart Church, Derry Rd on **Saturday 19th September at 9.00 am** when we will include prayers for bishop-elect, Bishop Router and prayers in honour of St Pio. On Monday 21st, Tuesday 22nd and Wednesday 23rd September, all are welcome to join in a tridium of prayer at various times – more details in next weekend's newsletter. Bishop Router has kindly agreed to offer Mass at **7.00 pm on Wednesday 23rd September**, the Feast of St Pio, at St Patrick's Church, Murlog. Further details to follow. People from all parishes in our pastoral area are warmly welcome to come along to this Mass.

Installation of Bishop Michael Router As the diocese prepares to celebrate the joyous occasion of the installation of Bishop Router as Bishop of Derry on Sunday 20th September, parishioners throughout the diocese are invited to participate in a Tridium of Masses, on Friday 18th, Saturday 19th & Sunday 20th September. This is an important occasion for all of us in the diocese and people are invited to pray as a community or at home as a family or individually. We invoke the intercession of

the Holy Spirit and the words 'Come Holy Spirit'. So too, we pray for the presence of Our Lady and protection of St Michael the Archangel and of course the intercession of St John Vianney and St Pio.

For the pastoral area, Mass will celebrated as follows:

Friday 18th September:

8.00 am: Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

10.00 am: Church of the Immaculate Conception

11.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Murlog

Saturday 19th September:

9.00 am: Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

and in turn the usual Vigil Masses (19th September) and morning Masses (20th September), the 25th Sunday in Ordinary Time.

Requiescant in Pace We offer our sympathy to the family and friends of

Chloe McShane, Moorlough Rd, Strabane

Mickey McAteer, Carrigullin Rd, Strabane

Kathleen O'Hagan, Cloughfin, Ballindrait, Lifford

Anniversaries Eric Adams (Canada), Seamus Browne, Jim Burns, Ellen Clarke, James Coyle, Jimmy Coyle, James Crawford, Joseph Crawford, Robert Devereux, Joe Doherty, Margaret Doherty, John Dolan, Marcella Edginton, Jonathan Gallagher, Paddy Gallagher, Brian Harte, Angela Hegarty, Brenda Hume, Michael Hunt, James Lannon, Bernadette McAleer, Eileen McBride, Jean McElwee, Nan McGettigan,

Sarah McGettigan-Porter, Artie McGinley, Seamus McLaughlin, Catherine O'Brien, Mollie O'Kane, Bridie Pollock, Charlie Pollock, Mary Potts, Mary Quinn, Bert Ridewood, Ned Rodgers. May they rest in peace.

Thank You for your generosity to last week's collections

Leckpatrick: £1,578.87

Clonleigh: €1,421.81

Camus: £1,957.26.

Thanks also to those who pay by standing order.

9.45am Mass on Sundays in Murlog Chapel is live on Finn Valley Community Radio.

Legion of Mary An urgent appeal for new members to join us. Role includes visitation of nursing homes, promotion of the rosary with the pilgrim statue and weekly meetings. Time commitment of approx 3 hrs per wk. Meeting on Thursday mornings at 11 am in St Pat's Hall. Please contact Margaret Harte: 028 71883159.

Readings for Sunday 20th September:

1st Reading: Isaiah 55:6-9

Psalm: 145:2-3, 8-9, 17-18

2nd Reading: Philipians 1:20c-24, 27a

Gospel: Matthew 20:1-16

Saints of the Coming Week:

Monday: The Exultation of the Cross

Tuesday: Our Lady of Sorrows

Wednesday: St Cornelius, pope and St Cyprian, bishop, martyrs

Thursday: St Hildegard of Bingen, virgin and doctor of the Church,

St Robert Bellarmine, bishop & doctor of the Church

Saturday: St Januarius, bishop & martyr

Parking at Immaculate Conception Church You are asked to note that parking in the grounds of the church is restricted to those attending Mass or praying in the church. Each day there is pedestrian access to the church at the front entrance. These gates will always remain open, however the main gate will generally close each day after morning Mass. In circumstances for funerals or weddings, the main gates will remain open. We ask you to respect this decision and thank you for your understanding and co-operation. The driveway to the parochial house is private property and we ask you to refrain from parking on the driveway on a daily basis. We again thank you for your understanding and co-operation.

Eucharistic Adoration takes place on

Monday from **10.30 am – 1.00 pm** in **St Patrick's Church, Murlog** and

Wednesday from **8.30 am – 5.30 pm** in **Sacred Heart Church, Derry Rd.** Everyone is welcome to come and spend some time in the presence of the Blessed Sacrament.

The Contemplative Prayer Group meets on Mondays at 8.00 pm in the Pastoral Office, 27 Butcher Street, Strabane. Everyone welcome.

The Columban Young Adults are a new group for those aged 18 – 30 in the diocese, who are seeking a community of like-minded young adults who have Christ at the centre of their lives. Our September event will be a Holy Hour and meditation on Thursday 17th September at 7.00 pm at Our Lady of Lourdes Church, Steelstown, Derry, delivered by Fr Declan McGeehan. The meditation will be followed by Solemn Benediction and light refreshments. We are actively seeking new members- please come along and bring a friend!

Eucharistic Adoration Derry Diocese is renewing and developing its Diocesan Adoration Lay Committee to increase the practice of Eucharistic Adoration in parishes throughout the diocese. You are welcome to an Information Meeting on Wednesday 30th September at 8 pm in the Drummond Hotel, 2 Main St, Ballykelly, BT49 9HP. Registration / light refreshments from 7.30 pm. All welcome.

Job Opportunity Derry Diocesan Trust invites applications for the post of sacristan at Granaghan (Swatragh) parish. 12 hrs per week. Rate of pay: £12.88 per hr. Contact recruitment@derrydiocese.org / 028 71262302. Closing date: 15th September 2026.

Human Life International Ireland Fr L Carney (USA), international speaker and popular author, Provincial Tour of Ireland. Join us for the Ulster event at Canal Court Hotel, Newry on 29th Sept at 6:45pm with 1st class relic of St Thérèse.

Season of Creation Water heals, restores, and makes creation flourish, but it also challenges us to recognise ecological damage, embrace our interconnectedness, and immerse ourselves in the responsibility of caring for and restoring our Common Home. May this season be a path for the healing of the earth and human well-being to flourish together. Please visit <https://youtu.be/xVVZ8LSpcRk>

Blessing of Bikers & Motorcycles today (Sunday) at 1.30 pm in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt. Following blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLI Station, to present a donation to RNLI. Mass will be celebrated on 13th September at 11.30 am in St Patrick's Chapel, DUNGIVEN for deceased bikers. All welcome.

Coffee Morning in aid of Foyle Hospice in Murphy's on the Green on Friday 25th September from 9.30 am – 12.30 pm. Prize draw included at £1 per line. A great range of prizes up for grabs. Draw at 1 pm on the day. Hope to see you all there.

Queen's University Catholic Chaplaincy reopens on Monday 14th September, with weekday Masses and our semester programme resuming. The first Sunday Mass will be celebrated on 20th Sept at the earlier time of **7.00 pm**. New or returning student? Find out about what's on, ways to connect and get involved, and student accommodation at Ryan Hall at qubcatholic.org and on our socials. Staff and alumni are always welcome too. Visit our newly renewed Chaplaincy at 28 Elmwood Ave for Mass, Confessions or candle-lighting — and call into Mosaic for some of the best coffee, hot lunches and home-baked treats in South Belfast!

Michael English Church Concert This evening of faith, hope and inspiration takes place on Friday 2nd October at 7.15 pm, in St Patrick's Church, Keenaught, Desertmartin. Tickets (£30) available at Heron's Gift Shop, Draperstown, Moneyneena Post Office, Ballinascreen and Desertmartin Parish offices, or online with Eventbrite: <https://www.eventbrite.co.uk/e/michael-english-band-fundraising-concert-tickets-1996641829460>

Lough Derg Day Retreats September 15, 19, 20 – a day of prayer, reflection and spiritual renewal. Visit www.loughderg.org All welcome.

Parish Bingo and Lucky Four in St Pat's Hall on Thursdays at 8 pm. All welcome.

Trócaire Could you help share the true spirit of Christmas? Each year, volunteers in parishes across Ireland set up a small stall after Masses to sell Trócaire's Gifts of Change: meaningful gifts that make a real difference to families living in poverty around the world. We provide everything you need including training and support. All we ask is a little time and a big heart. Last Christmas, 50 parishes took part — and we'd love to grow that number this year! If you would like to find out more, please email Mark at mark.mcmahon@trocaire.org or call 028 9080 8030.

Weekend Mass Schedule

Immaculate Conception: Saturday Vigil: **4.30 pm**; Sunday: **11.00 am**

Sacred Heart, Derry Road: Sunday: **12.15 pm**

St Patrick's, Clonleigh: Saturday Vigil: **6.30 pm**; Sunday: **9.45 am**

St Mary's, Cloughcor: Sunday: 8.30 am (13th Sept – alternate Sundays – 27th Sept)

St Joseph's, Glenmornan: Sunday: 8.30 am (20th Sept – alternate Sundays – 4th Oct)

Weekday Mass Schedule

Monday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford

Tuesday: **10.00 am:** Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Wednesday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

(followed by **Eucharistic Adoration** until 5.30 pm).